

EU Drug Market: Drivers and facilitators — Technology and innovation



Innovations across a range of areas have become key enablers for criminal networks throughout the drug supply chain. These include new methods and techniques used to produce drugs, yielding higher outputs, products with higher potency or purity, and novel consumer products; and continuous advancements in the digital sphere, as seen in the ongoing adaptation of online drug distribution models.

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Innovation in drug production and supply

Although a number of different factors affect levels of drug production, recent innovations in production techniques and equipment have resulted in higher outputs, products with higher potency or purity, and a broader range of consumer products.

For example, innovations in agronomic techniques and equipment have been applied to coca plants in Latin America, as well as industrial cannabis cultivation sites in Europe (see [EU Drug Market: Cannabis](#)). In Europe, such innovations are linked to higher cannabis herb and resin outputs, higher-potency cannabis and a more diverse range of cannabis consumer products. Another key innovation in cannabis production is the continuous emergence of new semi-synthetic cannabinoids, which are made by processing naturally occurring cannabinoids such as cannabidiol (see [EU Drug Market: Cannabis](#)).

Innovations in cocaine production appear to have contributed to an oversupply of cocaine in the global supply chain (see [EU Drug Market: Cocaine](#)). Among the innovations is the re-oxidation of cocaine base, which is a sophisticated method used in Colombia that increases the efficiency of cocaine production. Collaboration between European and Latin American networks to produce cocaine in Europe, using chemicals and equipment of higher quality, is also driving innovation in this area.

Innovations in methamphetamine production are also taking place in Europe, particularly in the resolution-racemisation-recycling (RRR) process (see [EU Drug Market: Methamphetamine](#)), which has increased the efficiency and output of methamphetamine production. Collaboration and knowledge exchange between Mexican and European criminal networks is also driving innovation and poses a key threat.

While amphetamine production appears to be relatively stable and high in Europe, there have been recent signals of changes in methods (see [EU Drug Market: Amphetamine](#)). In particular, the so-called nitrostyrene method may become more prominent in the future, reflecting the adaptability and resilience of synthetic drug producers, who change their methods in response to (or in anticipation of) changes in the availability of chemicals. Importantly, the nitrostyrene method can be used to circumvent producers' reliance on benzyl methyl ketone (BMK) and its alternative chemicals, underscoring the continuous innovation seen in the use of new chemicals and precursors for illicit drug production (see Section [Precursor innovation](#)).

Precursor innovation

Innovations in the use of chemicals and precursors have led to transformational developments in illicit synthetic drug production. In Europe, producers have shifted from the use of highly controlled drug precursors to the use of non-regulated chemicals that can be easily converted to those precursors, or even chemicals that can be directly transformed into various synthetic drugs (see [EU Drug Market: Methamphetamine](#)). As well as confirming that drug producers are becoming more adept at borrowing techniques from the pharmaceutical industry and applying them to the illicit drugs trade in order to evade detection, these developments present a challenge to the international precursor control regime.

A potential future threat in this area is the application of artificial intelligence and related technologies such as large language models (Europol, 2023a) to identify new chemicals and molecules that could be used in illicit drug production (see Box [Artificial intelligence](#)). Importantly, the pharmaceutical industry currently uses artificial intelligence in the drug discovery and development process (Qureshi et al., 2023).

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence is the ability of a machine to display human-like capabilities such as reasoning, learning, planning and creativity. While some artificial intelligence technologies have been used for over 50 years, recent advances in computing power and new algorithms have led to major breakthroughs. Artificial intelligence is now seen as central to the digital transformation of society and has become an EU priority.

As part of its digital strategy, the European Union is in the process of regulating artificial intelligence to ensure that these systems can be used in a safe, transparent, traceable, non-discriminatory and environmentally friendly way (EPRS, 2023).

Chemical masking of drugs

There have also been innovations in the concealment of drugs using chemical masking. This involves modifying the drug into a new substance, which is harder to detect by customs and law enforcement agencies. For example, producers chemically conceal cocaine hydrochloride, cocaine base and cocaine paste in carrier materials (such as charcoal, coco pulp and plastics). The extraction of the cocaine from these carrier materials usually takes place in dedicated ‘secondary extraction facilities’ in Europe. The cocaine extracted from carrier materials in base form must subsequently be transformed into cocaine hydrochloride, either in the same facility or in a dedicated ‘base to hydrochloride’ illicit laboratory (see [EU Drug Market: Cocaine](#)).

Another new modus operandi is the smuggling of heroin dissolved in liquids along the main trafficking routes for Afghan opiates to Europe (see [EU Drug Market: Heroin and other opioids](#)). A number of seizures between 2020 and 2021 involved several hundred litres of heroin in liquid form (typically concealed in the fuel tanks of vehicles) and intended for countries in eastern Europe, the Baltic region, Türkiye and western Europe. However, so far, no liquid heroin seizures have been reported in the European Union.

Digitally enabled drug markets

Surface web

The surface web (see Figure [Surface web, deep web and darknet](#)), including legitimate e-commerce platforms and social media, is an important medium for the sale of new psychoactive substances (NPS), misused medicines (including falsified and counterfeit medicines), illicit drugs, drug precursors and related chemicals. Large and highly flexible criminal structures have been identified in relation to online NPS shops in particular. An example of Member States efforts focussed on restricting the use of the surface web in NPS distribution is the multi-agency approach taken in Germany – supported by the EU Internal Security Fund DrAIN (Disruption and Analysis of the Internet NPS Market) project (Bayerisches Landeskriminalamt, 2021). While this has resulted in the closure of a number of online NPS shops, it is unclear whether German retailers have stopped selling these substances altogether or have relocated to darknet markets or social media. Further monitoring, analysis and investigation are required to determine how long-lasting this effect will be.

Surface web, deep web and darknet

Also known as the '**visible web**', including legitimate e-commerce platforms and social media. That part of the internet that can be found by link-crawling techniques used by typical search engines like Google or Bing.

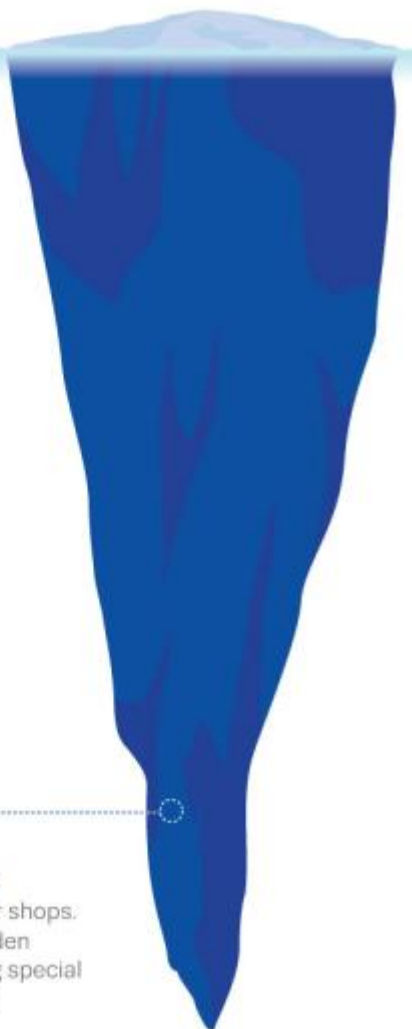
Surface web 4%

Deep web 96%

Also known as the '**invisible web**'. Content here is not accessible to search engines and includes a wide variety of different types including dynamic web pages, private sites, blocked sites and limited access networks.

Darknet

Part of the deep web, also known as the '**darknet**', hosting markets and vendor shops. Content is intentionally hidden and is only accessible using special web browsers such as TOR.



Social networks and instant messenger apps

Drug sales on social media platforms appear to be gaining in prominence, but there is relatively little research exploring their place in the wider technology-based drug markets (see Box [European Web Survey on Drugs: information on online purchases](#)). Furthermore, given the convenience and ease of use of these platforms, there is potential for them to amplify the various risks associated with drug use (Oksanen et al., 2021) (see Box [Motivations for buying and selling drugs on social media platforms](#)).

European Web Survey on Drugs: information on online purchases

The 2021 European Web Survey on Drugs (EWSD) covered 21 EU Member States and Switzerland. In the survey, 48 469 respondents reported having used drugs in the past 12 months (see [Overview of data and methods](#)). Of these, 30 201 specified how they usually obtained the drug. Although the majority usually bought the drug from a dealer (86 %), some also reported using the darknet (12 %), social media (11 %) or the surface web (4 %) (multiple response options were allowed). While this information provides a useful insight into the various methods used to buy drugs across Europe, it should be noted that the sample is not representative (of Europe or of participating countries) and may be skewed more towards younger groups of people who use drugs and who are more likely to use the internet.

Motivations for buying and selling drugs on social media platforms

Research is beginning to reveal the motivations of users on these platforms, including convenience, speed of service and ease of use, particularly in comparison to darknet markets (van der Sanden et al., 2021). Although there is a lack of research into the motivation of dealers, the benefits are likely to include access to a large customer base and the ability to do business directly while retaining a degree of anonymity. Further research in this area would help to improve our understanding of the motivations and behaviours of both buyers and sellers.

Social media includes a wide range of digital platforms designed for communication. These include image-sharing platforms, instant messaging apps and online forums. There are different levels of drug market openness across these platforms, ranging from public, where vendors make their profile publicly available, to private, where drug-related content is restricted to pre-screened users.

Most social media platforms appear to be used as marketplaces for illicit drugs (see Box [Online ethnography: examining drug distribution on social media platforms in Europe](#)). Yet there are significant challenges involved in designing and conducting research in this area: social media content can be temporary, fragmented and rapidly changing; and messages are almost always encrypted or otherwise difficult to access. The terminology used also changes rapidly, and, unlike darknet markets – which often have a global reach – dealers on social media are often more local, with a regional or city focus. As such, research into these activities may require language processing.

Online ethnography: examining drug distribution on social media platforms in Europe

Online ethnography (netnography) has enabled a closer examination of drug distribution through social media platforms in selected European countries (Denmark, Norway, Sweden and Germany) (Demant and Bjerre Aagesen, 2022). This has provided insights into social media drug markets in Europe, especially on Snapchat (Denmark, Norway and Sweden) and Reddit (Denmark and to a lesser extent Sweden). Meanwhile, accessing drug markets on Facebook and Instagram appears to be more difficult, potentially as a result of tight moderation of such content (Demant and Bjerre Aagesen, 2022).

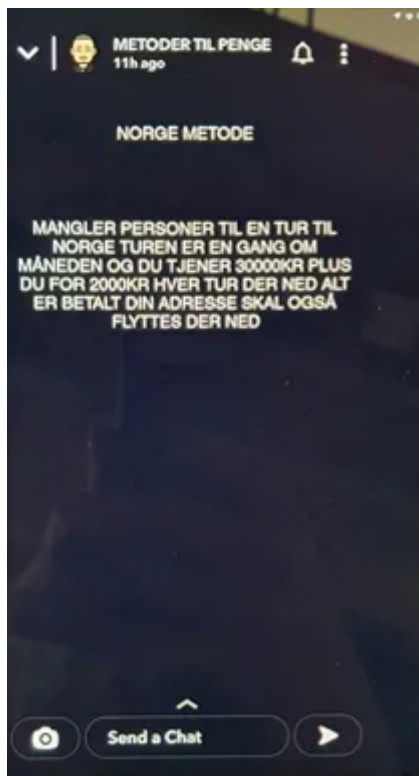
Vendors on social media use captions, hashtags and emojis to enable potential buyers to search for drugs (Demant and Bakken, 2019). Geographical areas of operation may also be indicated to

allow potential buyers to identify local vendors (Moeller, 2022). Vendors are then contacted, either through the messaging function of the platform or via instant messaging apps, to conduct the transaction. While some transactions are conducted in-person and paid for in cash, most use online payment systems, with the product being shipped to the buyer's door or to a pick-up point (Demant and Bakken, 2019).

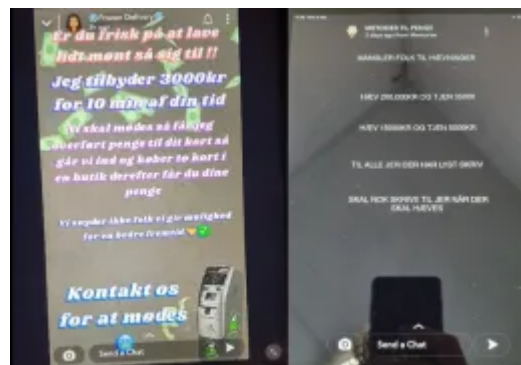
Given the local dimension of social media drug markets and their interaction with offline markets, they have the potential to influence the operation of 'street' markets. Future research would need to investigate the intersection between digitally enabled drug markets and traditional 'street' markets, for example, by exploring the risks of being conned, robbed or arrested. This could inform appropriate policy decisions and responses (van der Sanden et al., 2022).

Use of social media to recruit low-level drug market facilitators

In addition to drug sales, social media is also used to recruit low-level drug market facilitators. Accounts have been identified on Snapchat that are dedicated to the recruitment of individuals for drug-related tasks, including drug smuggling and cross-border drug transportation. Using multiple notifications ('stories' or direct messages) per day, they appear to offer considerable sums of money to individuals willing to transport drugs across international borders (see Screenshot [A Snapchat notice from a drug-dealing account seeking to recruit a 'drug mule'](#)) or to make their personal bank account available for large transactions or cash withdrawals ('money muling') (see Screenshot [Snapchat notices from drug-dealing accounts offering money for drug-related services](#)) (Demant and Bjerre Aagesen, 2022). Money muling has been identified in some Member States as an emerging method of money laundering (Europol, 2023b).



A drug mule is sought for 'monthly trips to Norway' (from Denmark), with the sum of DKK 30 000 (EUR 4 000) plus DKK 2 000 (around EUR 270) offered for each trip. The advertisement states that 'everything is paid for and you will also need to move your address' to Norway. Source: Demant and Bjerre Aagesen, 2022.



Snapchat notices from drug-dealing accounts offering DKK 3 000 (EUR 400) to buyers of mobile phone cards (left); and DKK 35 000 (EUR 4 700) per transaction to individuals for the withdrawal of DKK 200 000 (EUR 26 855) (right). Source: Demant and Bjerre Aagesen, 2022.

Darknet markets

Darknet markets have been active for more than a decade. They enable buyers and sellers to conduct transactions online with a high level of anonymity. These markets are based on a combination of digital technologies, namely anonymous communication technology (e.g. Tor – Dingledine et al., 2004) and pseudo-anonymous or anonymous payment systems (Nakamoto, 2009). These characteristics have made them attractive for buyers and sellers of illicit drugs. As such, it is important to understand darknet trends when developing both supply- and demand-side drug policies.

Darknet markets tend to be global and operate in English, although some are focused on a particular country or language group. Although sale and trade volumes on darknet markets have fluctuated over the years, reflecting the frequent entry into and exit from the ecosystem by multiple individual markets, the darknet market ecosystem is currently considered to be active, albeit at lower levels than previously observed. A number of factors, such as more frequent scams,

voluntary closures and law enforcement activity, appear to have a considerable impact on drug supply via darknet markets.

Data from the monitoring period, 2020-2022, show a darknet market ecosystem characterised by high turnover and fragmentation. In recent years, many markets have been 'exit-scammed', whereby those in control accumulate customers' funds and subsequently exit the darknet ecosystem without fulfilling orders, or have been taken down by law enforcement agencies. An example of this is Empire, a leading darknet market that stopped operations in August 2020, departing abruptly and failing to fulfil pending orders. However, in late 2021, a number of markets also voluntarily closed and exited in a relatively orderly fashion once they had achieved their profit objectives and without misleading their customers (including some of the largest such as WhiteHouse, Cannazon and Torrez). Numerous new markets also appeared but were mostly short-lived, creating a highly fragmented environment.

The darknet market ecosystem continues to consist of many short-lived markets (see Figure [Darknet markets ecosystem: lifetime and reason for closure of over 150 global darknet markets offering drugs, sorted by date](#)). Over the next five years, it is expected that this scene will continue to fragment. While some larger, multi-vendor, multi-commodity markets may survive, there will likely be an increasing number of vendor shops and smaller markets (see Box [Vendor shops](#)). International law enforcement therefore needs to focus on these smaller markets.

Darknet markets ecosystem: lifetime and reason for closure of over 150 global darknet markets offering drugs, sorted by date

Key

O = '**Open**': market still operating at time of writing.

E = '**Exit scam**': market operator closes the site down suddenly, taking the money held in escrow without fulfilling the orders

V = '**Voluntary exit**': market is closed with the mutual consent of those involved and without known losses to users

R = '**Raided**': shut down by law enforcement

H = '**Hacked**': market closure precipitated by a hack or as a result of de-anonymisation

U = '**Unknown reason**' the exact reason for closure is not know

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Vendor shops

A consequence of the high market turnover in the darknet sphere is the growing use of vendor shops, and the use of social media and instant messaging apps for drug distribution. Unlike markets controlled by a third party and in which a large number of vendors may be active, vendor shops are run by a single vendor. Well-established vendors with high trust levels and a strong reputation are more likely to set up their own vendor shops, where they may be able to continue doing business only with the clientele they have established on markets that have closed.

These ongoing developments underscore the dynamic nature of darknet markets – which evolve constantly to mitigate threats and exploit new opportunities – and their ability to introduce or adopt new technologies to evade interdiction. Enhanced monitoring capacity in this area, and targeted law enforcement action, is thus crucial to ensure that responses keep pace with developments (see Box [Disrupting darknet ‘information hubs’](#)).

Disrupting darknet ‘information hubs’

As criminals diversify their distribution channels, law enforcement agencies have broadened the scope and targets of their operations to include ‘information hubs’ on the darknet. Information hubs are websites (such as Darknetlive and dark.fail) that provide extensive and up-to-date information about darknet markets and are central to the darknet community (Ladegaard, 2019). Disrupting these hubs thus restricts information about how to access darknet markets and which of them are operational or trustworthy, making it potentially more difficult for users to purchase or sell drugs (Popper, 2019).

Ongoing innovation in darknet markets, and their intersection with social media and surface web applications, has caused further complexity for monitoring and interdiction. For example, a vendor shop bot for direct sales – known as Televend – emerged in 2021, powered by the instant messaging app Telegram and supported by a Tor vendor panel (see Screenshot [Televend: automated direct deals platform](#) and Box [Online drug sales automation](#)).

By adding Televend as a contact on the Telegram app and following a few additional steps, users could access a list of drug vendors. The vendor shop was operated by a bot around the clock, managing purchase requests and all administrative functions. The service provided security to vendors as well as negating the risks of distributed denial-of-service (DDoS) attacks.

Although Televend was compromised in September 2021, it provided proof of concept for an innovative combination of darknet market and messaging app technologies for trading illicit drugs. Televend-like markets could potentially attract users who already routinely scroll through social media content and have less technological know-how than darknet market users (Barratt et al., 2022). Considering the advantages for users, including convenience and a lower risk of scams, and higher protection for vendors, it is conceivable that variations of this model will emerge in future or are already operational. Other potential ways for criminals to exploit new technologies, such as artificial intelligence and machine learning, may also be expected to emerge and spread in the future (UNICRI and Europol, 2020).

Online drug sales automation

Some darknet market vendors appear to be diversifying their business to include social media and encrypted instant messaging apps, and automating the trade processes through self-executing mechanisms like 'smart' contracts and bots. The increasing use of these mainstream social media and messaging platforms by criminals poses challenges for law enforcement agencies across the European Union. It also highlights the need for darknet investigators to broaden their focus to capture illicit drug-related activity on other platforms beyond the darknet markets.



Televend

Fully automated Vendor shop bot powered by Telegram for Direct-Dealers

About

Televend is a direct deal platform which uses Telegram bots to interface with customers via a shop front inside the app and a Tor based .onion vendor panel for vendors to manage orders and customers, completely automated.

Vendors

If a vendor has proof of reputation and their Public PGP can be validated against other sources such as trusted forums we will label them with *VERIFIED* status.

Country of dispatch

Shipping country

Last seen

Feedback

Any country

Any country

Any

Any

Search

Televend: automated direct deals platform. Source: Web-IQ.

References

Consult the list of [references](#) used in this module.

The source data for the figure Darknet markets ecosystem: lifetime and reason for closure of over 150 global darknet markets offering drugs, sorted by date may be found below. See also this [data set in our Data catalogue](#).

Darknet markets

Market name	Start date	End date	Status / reason for closure
The Farmer's Market	01/01/2010	01/03/2012	Raided
Silk Road	31/01/2011	02/10/2013	Raided
Black Market Reloaded	30/06/2011	02/12/2013	Hacked
Sheep Marketplace	28/02/2013	29/11/2013	Exit scam

Market name	Start date	End date	Status / reason for closure
Atlantis	26/03/2013	20/09/2013	Exit scam
BuyItNow	30/04/2013	17/02/2014	Voluntary exit
Deepbay	30/06/2013	04/11/2013	Exit scam
Budster	10/10/2013	20/10/2013	Exit scam
Project Black Flag	14/10/2013	28/10/2013	Exit scam
Pandora	21/10/2013	05/11/2014	Raided
Silk Road 2.0	06/11/2013	05/11/2014	Raided
TorMarket	07/11/2013	22/12/2013	Exit scam
BlackBox Market	12/11/2013	01/02/2014	Voluntary exit
Dream Market	15/11/2013	24/03/2019	Voluntary exit
The Marketplace	28/11/2013	09/11/2014	Voluntary exit
Pirate Market	29/11/2013	15/08/2014	Exit scam
FloMarket	01/12/2013	01/01/2014	Hacked
Black Market	02/12/2013	05/11/2014	Raided
FreeBay	02/12/2013	28/02/2014	Voluntary exit
Blue Sky	03/12/2013	05/11/2014	Raided
Agora	03/12/2013	06/09/2015	Voluntary exit
Tortuga	16/12/2013	05/01/2014	Voluntary exit
TorBay	18/12/2013	20/04/2014	Voluntary exit
White Rabbit	23/12/2013	01/02/2014	Exit scam
Outlaw Market	29/12/2013	23/05/2017	Unknown
GreyRoad	04/01/2014	01/02/2014	Voluntary exit
DrugList	08/01/2014	28/02/2014	Exit scam
Evolution	14/01/2014	18/03/2015	Exit scam
Doge Road	18/01/2014	13/03/2014	Exit scam
Cantina	20/01/2014	07/02/2014	Hacked
Tor Bazaar	26/01/2014	05/11/2014	Raided
DarkBay	30/01/2014	01/05/2014	Voluntary exit
Breaking Bad	01/02/2014	06/02/2014	Voluntary exit
TorEscrow	02/02/2014	19/04/2014	Exit scam
Black Goblin Market	03/02/2014	04/02/2014	Hacked
Cannabis Road	03/02/2014	07/02/2014	Hacked
Utopia	03/02/2014	11/02/2014	Raided
BlackBank Market	05/02/2014	18/05/2015	Exit scam
Cloud 9	11/02/2014	05/11/2014	Raided
Darknet Nation	19/02/2014	01/03/2014	Hacked
Sanitarium Market	20/02/2014	28/03/2014	Voluntary exit
Hansa Marketplace	09/03/2014	20/03/2014	Voluntary exit
Red Sun Marketplace	20/03/2014	23/03/2014	Hacked
EXXTACY	23/03/2014	24/03/2014	Hacked
Topix	25/03/2014	05/11/2014	Raided
Hydra	27/03/2014	05/11/2014	Raided

Market name	Start date	End date	Status / reason for closure
Cannabis Road 2	28/03/2014	25/08/2014	Hacked
Mr Nice Guy	29/03/2014	20/04/2014	Voluntary exit
Andromeda	05/04/2014	18/11/2014	Exit scam
Silk Street	08/04/2014	04/08/2014	Exit scam
Underground Market	09/04/2014	26/08/2014	Voluntary exit
Pigeon Market	14/04/2014	07/05/2014	Voluntary exit
1776	19/04/2014	02/10/2014	Voluntary exit
Alpaca	20/04/2014	05/11/2014	Raided
Tortuga 2	23/04/2014	17/06/2014	Voluntary exit
TOM	10/05/2014	18/12/2014	Exit scam
Deepzon	14/05/2014	13/07/2014	Voluntary exit
Onionshop	18/05/2014	17/09/2014	Hacked
Area51	20/06/2014	24/01/2015	Exit scam
Middle Earth Marketplace	22/06/2014	04/11/2015	Exit scam
Freedom Market	16/09/2014	25/09/2014	Voluntary exit
Cannabis Road 3	06/10/2014	05/11/2014	Exit scam
Diabolus/SR3	13/10/2014	12/02/2017	Unknown
Nucleus Marketplace	24/10/2014	13/04/2016	Exit scam
Panacea	27/10/2014	13/02/2015	Voluntary exit
Silk Road 3.1	10/12/2014	31/07/2017	Exit scam
Abraxas	13/12/2014	05/11/2015	Exit scam
AlphaBay	22/12/2014	28/06/2017	Raided
Silk Road Reloaded	13/01/2015	27/02/2016	Unknown
Free Market	14/01/2015	26/02/2015	Voluntary exit
T•chka	30/01/2015	28/11/2019	Exit scam
Crypto Market	14/02/2015	12/02/2017	Exit scam
Kiss	19/02/2015	16/05/2015	Unknown
Mr Nice Guy 2	21/02/2015	14/10/2015	Exit scam
Ironclad	17/03/2015	25/03/2015	Exit scam
The Majestic Garden	18/03/2015		Open
TheRealDeal	09/04/2015	22/10/2016	Unknown
Havana/Absolem	13/04/2015	22/05/2015	Hacked
Oxygen	16/04/2015	27/08/2015	Exit scam
East India Company	28/04/2015	01/01/2016	Exit scam
Haven	05/05/2015	06/06/2015	Exit scam
Zanzibar Spice	07/05/2015	14/06/2015	Voluntary exit
Anarchia	07/05/2015	09/05/2016	Unknown
Tornado	12/05/2015	20/05/2015	Unknown
Horizon Market	23/05/2015	08/07/2015	Exit scam
Agape	29/05/2015	04/06/2015	Voluntary exit
Poseidon	02/06/2015	29/06/2015	Exit scam
Amazon Dark	08/06/2015	25/10/2015	Exit scam

Market name	Start date	End date	Status / reason for closure
Simply Bear	20/06/2015	21/10/2015	Exit scam
Hansa	09/08/2015	20/07/2017	Raided
Valhalla	01/10/2015	01/02/2019	Raided
Hydra (2)	01/12/2015	05/04/2022	Raided
Acropolis	17/12/2015	22/06/2017	Voluntary exit
Apple Market	23/02/2016	21/07/2017	Unknown
House of Lions Market	14/03/2016	27/07/2017	Unknown
CGMC	07/06/2016	14/05/2019	Voluntary exit
Minerva	13/07/2016	22/06/2017	Unknown
TradeRoute	01/08/2016	15/10/2017	Exit scam
Wall Street Market	25/10/2016	16/04/2019	Raided
RSClub Market	27/10/2016	26/10/2017	Hacked
Berlusconi Market	01/11/2016	27/09/2019	Raided
Zion Market	01/12/2016	17/05/2018	Exit scam
OW Market	14/02/2017	01/05/2018	Unknown
Infinite Market	01/04/2017	08/05/2018	Unknown
Placemarket	13/04/2017	22/06/2017	Unknown
Libertas	14/10/2017	19/06/2019	Voluntary exit
Agora Reloaded	08/11/2017	01/01/2018	Hacked
Empire Market	01/02/2018	24/08/2020	Exit scam
Serpent Market	08/02/2018	01/08/2018	Unknown
Olympus Market	24/02/2018	05/09/2018	Exit scam
Apollon	09/03/2018		Open
Cannazon	21/03/2018	14/11/2021	Voluntary exit
Agartha Market	19/04/2018	23/03/2021	Hacked
Rapture Market	21/04/2018	17/11/2018	Exit scam
Cryptonia	06/10/2018	23/11/2019	Exit scam
DIabolus/SR3	12/10/2018	01/05/2019	Exit scam
Tor Market	23/11/2018		Open
Enigma Market	16/02/2019	12/04/2020	Voluntary exit
Yellow Brick Market	18/02/2019	11/01/2021	Exit scam
Nightmare	01/04/2019	24/11/2019	Exit scam
Dreamalt	01/04/2019	30/03/2020	Exit scam
Genesis	01/05/2019	24/08/2019	Exit scam
Dark Market	20/06/2019	12/12/2021	Raided
Grey	01/07/2019	01/12/2019	Exit scam
Samsara	06/07/2019	09/11/2019	Exit scam
Monopoly Market	13/07/2019	28/12/2021	Unknown
Big Blue Market	15/08/2019	08/04/2021	Exit scam
WhiteHouse Market (WHM)	24/08/2019	12/10/2021	Voluntary exit
Darkbey	03/09/2019	01/07/2020	Unknown
Silk Road 4	06/09/2019	06/01/2021	Exit scam

Market name	Start date	End date	Status / reason for closure
Cannahome Market	15/09/2019	26/04/2022	Voluntary exit
Metropolis market	04/10/2019	30/06/2021	Voluntary exit
Avaris	18/10/2019	09/03/2020	Exit scam
Avior	27/10/2019	01/05/2020	Exit scam
Versus Market	12/12/2019	22/05/2022	Voluntary exit
Cypher Market	09/02/2020		Open
Square Market	13/02/2020	01/09/2020	Exit scam
Black market	20/02/2020	14/06/2020	Exit scam
Darkfox market	24/02/2020		Open
Europa Market	25/02/2020	20/05/2020	Exit scam
ToRReZ Market	28/02/2020	17/12/2021	Voluntary exit
ASAP	25/03/2020	28/07/2023	Voluntary exit
Icarus Market	26/03/2020	09/09/2020	Unknown
DeepSea	08/04/2020	14/10/2020	Exit scam
Yakuza market	08/04/2020		Open
Babylon	16/04/2020		Open
Archetyp	17/05/2020		Open
Dark0de (aka Dark0de Reborn)	24/05/2020	23/02/2022	Exit scam
Vice City	25/05/2020	27/07/2023	Exit scam
Daeva market	14/06/2020	28/02/2021	Unknown
Cartel Market	15/06/2020	24/12/2021	Unknown
Hyper Market	21/06/2020	26/10/2020	Voluntary exit
Tor2door Market	03/07/2020	14/09/2023	Exit scam
Corona Market	07/07/2020	14/03/2021	Exit scam
Neptune market	14/07/2020	25/02/2021	Unknown
Potluck market	25/08/2020	18/01/2021	Voluntary exit
Invictus	27/08/2020		Open
Phoenix Market	02/09/2020	12/01/2021	Voluntary exit
LimeMarket	14/09/2020		Open
Aurora Market	02/11/2020	04/05/2021	Exit scam
World Market	09/11/2020	08/03/2022	Exit scam
Incognito	14/01/2021		Open
Libery	21/01/2021		Open
Revolution Market	01/04/2021	01/06/2022	Voluntary exit
Hermes	01/04/2021		Open
Kingdom Market	19/04/2021	19/12/2023	Raided
UnionMarket	24/04/2021		Open
MGM Grand Market	26/04/2021		Open
Bohemia	01/05/2021		Open
The Hive	24/05/2021		Open
Nemesis	26/05/2021		Open
Victory Market	01/06/2021		Open

Market name	Start date	End date	Status / reason for closure
Chiron	04/08/2021		Open
Ares	08/08/2021		Open
Alphabay	08/08/2021	28/11/2022	Exit scam
Evil Corp	17/08/2021		Open
Casio Market	16/09/2021		Open
Abacus (Alphabet)	28/09/2021		Open
Quest	20/10/2021		Open
Kerberos	02/02/2022		Open
Alien	08/02/2022	04/07/2022	Hacked
Black Pyramid	03/03/2022		Open
Lion Marketplace	10/03/2022		Open
Asur	11/03/2022		Open
Omicron	30/03/2022	23/07/2022	Hacked
Cosmos	04/04/2022		Open
GrandBazaar	01/05/2022		Open
Solaris	14/05/2022		Open
Holy Grail	30/05/2022		Open
Courier	01/07/2022		Open
Cloud	05/07/2022	24/12/2022	Voluntary exit
DarkDock	14/07/2022		Open
Mellow	01/09/2022	25/04/2023	Voluntary exit
TorZon	12/09/2022		Open
Sonanza	20/09/2022		Open
Cannabia	01/11/2022		Open
Apocalypse	16/12/2022		Open
High supply	31/03/2023	01/09/2023	Voluntary exit
Euphoria	30/05/2023		Open

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